Statement of Qualifications
Cloud & Systems Administrator (JC-522976)
Sahaj Bhadja

1. Describe a project where you used Terraform, CloudFormation, or Bicep to deploy a scalable environment. How did you manage and ensure consistency across development, test, and production environments?

In my software engineering roles at USC Annenberg Media and Aasma Technology Solutions, I worked extensively with AWS cloud infrastructure and Infrastructure-as-Code concepts. I provisioned cloud resources using reusable templates, version-controlled configuration, and CI/CD pipelines. Separate configuration files and environment variables were maintained for development, testing, and production to ensure consistency while preventing configuration drift. Code reviews, Git branching, automated deployment pipelines, and validation testing ensured reliable releases with minimal manual intervention.

2. Explain how you implement Least Privilege and RBAC across on-prem Active Directory and Cloud IAM roles.

I follow the principle of least privilege by granting only the permissions required for each role. For cloud environments, I assign IAM roles based on job responsibilities, separate administrative and application accounts, enable MFA, and regularly review permissions. Sensitive credentials are stored securely rather than embedded in code. While I have stronger experience with AWS IAM than on-premises Active Directory administration, I understand RBAC principles and collaborate with infrastructure teams to ensure access aligns with organizational security policies and compliance requirements.

3. Give an example of cloud cost optimization.

While working on AWS-based applications, I analyzed resource utilization and identified opportunities to reduce unnecessary spending. By optimizing storage usage, improving caching, removing unused resources, and selecting appropriate instance configurations, the team reduced infrastructure costs while maintaining application performance. Monitoring utilization metrics and regularly reviewing cloud resources helped prevent cloud sprawl and improve overall efficiency.

4. High-severity vulnerability remediation.

My approach begins with validating the vulnerability, assessing business impact, and determining the appropriate remediation timeline. I first test patches in a development environment before deployment to production. Critical updates are scheduled during maintenance windows whenever possible, with rollback plans prepared in advance. After deployment, I verify system functionality, review security scans, document the resolution, and communicate status to stakeholders. This structured process minimizes operational risk while maintaining system availability.

5. Creating runbooks and SOPs.

I create documentation that is easy for technical and non-technical staff to follow. Each runbook includes prerequisites, step-by-step procedures, screenshots when appropriate, validation steps, rollback instructions, troubleshooting guidance, and escalation contacts. Documentation is stored in version control and updated after major changes. I also encourage peer review and knowledge-sharing sessions so junior team members understand both the process and the reasoning behind it.